

Case Description – recruitment process

Hiring a new associate or full professor at NTNU, is a process that involves several steps and actors. Before we describe this process, it is important to remember the organizational structure of the university. The university consists of 8 faculties and each faculty has a number of institutes. Each institute consists of a number of groups.

The hiring process is initiated when an institute determines that it wants to hire a new staff member. The reason for this could be that someone left or that a new position is created for strategic reasons. Based on the required profile, the institute writes an advertisement text for the position. This text is sent to the faculty, where it is assessed by the recruitment committee. This committee decides whether the position can be announced by checking it against the budget and the faculties recruitment plan for the coming five years.

If the position can be announced, it is put on Jobbnorge.no. Applicants can use this portal to apply for the advertised position. They upload all the required documents, such as cv, education certificates and scientific publications they want to be included in the assessment. After the deadline has passed, the application is closed.

The institute now appoints two people that form a so-called 'filtering' committee. They go through the list of applicants, and remove those that don't have a PhD, have the wrong background (so, no education within the required field), or an incomplete application (for example, no scientific publications included). This results in a new, often shorter, list of possible candidates. If there are no qualified applicants left, the position can be announced again, maybe with an extended deadline. It could also be decided to postpone the recruitment till a later point in time.

In the next step the applicants are assessed by an expert committee on their scientific, educational and scientific leadership qualities. This expert committee consists of three members: a professor/assoc professor from outside of Norway, a professor/assoc professor from a Norwegian university other than NTNU and a professor/assoc professor from the institute. The committee writes a report in which each applicant is assessed as qualified or not qualified. The ones that are qualified are ranked, where the one on place 1 is seen as being best qualified for the job.

The applicants ranked are invited for a trial lecture and an interview. The committee that assesses the trial lectures and performs the interviews, consists normally of the leader of the institute, the leader of the group the new position belongs to, a student representative and a human resource staff member. They extend the report of the expert committee with the information they have gathered, and they can change the ranking of the candidates. This extended report is sent to the faculty, where the recruitment committee can approve it or not. If it is approved the Human Resource department will send a job offer to the candidate ranked as 1. If he or she refuses the offer, the next candidate gets an offer. When a candidate has accepted, a contract is signed and the process is finished.

Task 1 (25 points)

Model the recruitment process described in the case using BPMN. Explain your modelling decisions.

Task 2 (15 points)

Business analytical studies of the process have shown that there are possibilities for improvement. The average time from advertising the job announcement to signing an employer contract, is about 266 days, which is considered to be too long (**NB: these figures are made up and are not representative for NTNU**). Main bottlenecks are around the work of the 'filtering' committee (takes on average: 24 days), and around the execution of trial lectures and interviews (average: 58 days). The reason why the filtering committee is a bottleneck is that it is difficult to find two people that want to do the job, and when having the job, they give it low priority. The reason why the trial lectures and interviews are a bottleneck is that the applicants have to come to NTNU to do these, and finding dates that fit is often problematic.

Suggest information systems that could help in removing/reducing these bottle necks. So, suggest the type of systems you would like to use, and how they would be used. Does implementing these systems change the process model from Task 1?

Task 3 (10 points)

One of the critical success factors for a university is that it succeeds in attracting the best scientists as their staff. Not being able to do so, affects its quality negatively. How would you position this threat in Porter's five forces model (see lecture Module 2.1)? If posting positions at Jobbnorge.no is the only strategy chosen by NTNU to guard itself against this threat, how would you assess this choice? Sufficient? Not sufficient? If not sufficient, which other strategies do you suggest? Motivate your answer.

Task 4 (15 points)

Google scholar (scholar.google.com) is a useful tool to find scientific publications on a topic of interest. It can also be used to find publications of a specific person, as well as statistics about how many publications this person has and his or her so-called citation index. This citation index is often used as an indication of scientific quality. Could this system be characterized as a knowledge management system? And in which part of the recruitment process you modeled, can this system be used? Explain your answer.

Task 5 (15 points)

NTNU has decided to digitalize the recruitment process as much as possible. An Enterprise Architecture (EA), as discussed in the lecture by John Krogstie, can be a valuable tool in such an effort. Describe how an EA can be used in this case, and discuss at least two benefits of using it.